

**CITY OF PASADENA
PUBLIC SAFETY COMMITTEE MINUTES
PASADENA CITY HALL
100 NORTH GARFIELD AVENUE
CITY HALL COUNCIL CHAMBER – S249
JULY 19, 2017
REGULAR MEETING**

OPENING

The Chair called the regular meeting of the Public Safety Committee to order at 6:20 p.m.

ROLL CALL:

Vice Mayor John J. Kennedy (Chair)
Councilmember Tyron Hampton
Councilmember Steve Madison (Absent)
Mayor Terry Tornek

Staff:

Steve Mermell, City Manager
Javan Rad, Chief Assistant City Attorney
Phillip Sanchez, Police Chief
Ara Maloyan, Director of Public Works Department
Michael Johnson, Director of Public Health Department
Richard Yee, Principal Engineer
Valerie Flores, Recording Secretary

PUBLIC COMMENT

No one appeared for public comment.

Steve Mermell, City Manager, provided a brief statement regarding an incident that occurred at Hotel Constance in 2016, which involved City personnel. Mr. Mermell noted that he is reviewing, in depth, the facts and circumstances of the incident with the assistance of the City Attorney's Office; after which it will be determined what, if any, information can be shared with the City Council and public. He also commented on the issue involving police reports and when they are taken, stating that the Police Department has related policies on the matter posted on the City's website, and that staff will present the policies to the Committee in the future, when appropriate.

INFORMATION ITEMS

Blue-Rich Lighting

Ara Maloyan, Director of Public Works Department, introduced the agenda item, and Richard Yee, Principal Engineer, provided a PowerPoint presentation summarizing the agenda item, and responded to questions.

Mr. Mermell reported that several emails were received from concerned citizens regarding blue-rich lighting, noted that the City is not in the process of replacing street lighting but that a discussion has taken place on the matter as part of the capital improvement budget discussions.

Donald Berry, Pasadena resident, expressed concerns regarding blue-rich lighting and its harmful effects on humans, stated a petition has been circulated and posted on the website

"Change.org" opposing blue-rich outdoor lighting, and asked the City to address commercial installations of such lighting.

The Mayor requested staff to provide information on the current zoning code regulation on lighting, requested that the Public Health Department examine the issue of high kelvin installations and whether the threat is serious enough for the City to: consider what is being done in terms of the City's own standards for existing lighting installations that do exceed the kelvin readings; and whether or not the City should modify the existing zoning regulations as it relates to lighting, with staff to report back to the Committee with its findings.

Councilmember Hampton echoed the Mayor's above comments, expressed concerns regarding the 5000 kelvin reading "induction light fixtures" that currently exist in certain areas of the city, highlighted the American Medical Association's (AMA) policy statement that encourages the use of 3000K or lower lighting for outdoor installations, urged staff to consider replacing or dimming the lights given AMA's above recommendation, and to bring forward a report to the Committee on the matter for consideration.

In response to Councilmember Hampton, Mr. Maloyan advised the Committee that the City has minimum standards for safety reasons in terms of street lighting, and spoke on a previously adopted resolution that doubled the intensity of street lights in the city for safety reasons, which he noted is above the Illuminating Engineering Society's (IES) recommendation.

Following discussion, the City Manager noted that staff will report back to the Committee with data on the number of existing induction lights in the city and what their readings are, on the private use aspects of such lights through the zoning code, information from the Public Health Department on the matter, as well as information on the appropriateness of reducing the intensity of street lights given that the City is currently operating above standard, which he noted would allow the Committee an opportunity to thoroughly discuss the matter and decide whether or not to recommend a change to the City Council.

In response to the Chair, Michael Johnson, Director of Public Health Department, responded to questions regarding the AMA's report as it relates to their findings on blue-rich lighting, noted that his staff has reviewed the report and related research on the matter and found that the research is relatively limited, and determined that more research is needed to determine the health effects of blue-rich street lighting.

Following discussion, the Chair agreed on the need for the Public Health Department and other appropriate staff to further examine the health effects of blue-rich lighting and report back to the Committee to address the issue in greater detail, include an inventory of existing induction lights in the city operating at 5000k, and to share any data from healthcare professionals on the matter, noting that such information will assist the City Council in determining its next step.

COLORADO STREET BRIDGE - SUICIDE MITIGATION PROPOSALS

Steve Mermell, City Manager, introduced the agenda item, Ara Maloyan, Director of Public Works Department, and Michael Johnson, Director of Public Health Department, provided a PowerPoint presentation reviewing the agenda item, and responded to questions.

Bruce Nolte, Pasadena resident
Diana Britt, Pasadena resident
Marci Solway, HOA Vista Dell Arroyo
Robert Law, Habitat for Humanity
Marty McBride, Desiderio Homeowners San Gabriel Valley
Habitat for Humanity
Claire Bogaard, Pasadena resident
Sue Mossman, Pasadena Heritage (submitted written material)
Mark Van Lue, San Gabriel Valley Habitat
Valerie E. Coachman-Moore, Pasadena resident
Solomon Moore, Pasadena resident
Mic Hansen, Pasadena resident
Jeff Michael, Pasadena resident
Patricia Speelman, Didi Hirsch Mental Health Services, Suicide Prevention Center
Ann Scheid, Pasadena resident
George Mac Pherson, Pasadena resident
Mary Dee Romney, San Rafael Neighborhoods Association (SRNA)

Councilmember Hampton thanked the public speakers, spoke in support for suicide mitigation proposals such as planting trees under the bridge (as stated by several public speakers), continued fencing along the ends/approaches of the bridge, as well as non-structural interventions such as surveillance cameras and/or citizen police officers patrolling the bridge.

The Mayor commented on the emergency and temporary measure involving the installation of temporary fencing at the alcove locations on the bridge, noting that such action would be appropriate at this time given the significant increase in the rate of incidents, recommended continuing the fencing along the ends/approaches of the bridge, thanked the public speakers for their input, namely as it relates to planting trees under the bridge, recommended that staff engage local architects and engineers and work together to find effective/successful ways to address the problem that are both cost effective and aesthetically pleasing. He also noted the importance of addressing the psychological aspect of the issue.

The Chair expressed support for the installation of temporary fencing at the alcove locations on an emergency basis, which he noted would allow the City an opportunity to find a more permanent solution. He thanked City staff for the thorough presentation and for educating the Committee and the community on the matter, and requested staff to report back to the Committee with a recommendation sooner than later, with the information to be presented to the full City Council for consideration in the future.

On the order of the Chair, and by consensus of the Committee, the information was received and filed.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

May 1, 2017 – Regular Meeting

The above agenda item was held for approval at a future Committee meeting.

JULY 4, 2017 FIREWORKS OVERVIEW

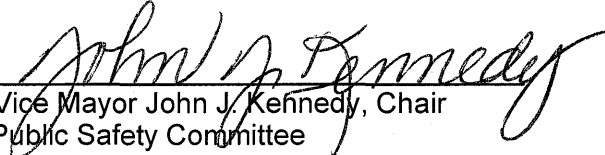
The above agenda item was held for discussion at a future Committee meeting.

ADJOURNMENT

On the order of the Chair, the regular meeting of the Public Safety Committee was adjourned at 8:25 p.m.

ATTEST:


Valerie Flores
Recording Secretary


Vice Mayor John J. Kennedy, Chair
Public Safety Committee